

What's the Business Case for Green Electronics

While many manufacturers have already switched on to green electronics, others are still thinking over what's in it for them. Take a look at the incentives and cost of going green, as also some success stories



(Image courtesy: <http://nichemanna.com>)

UMA GUPTA

There is a mounting pressure on electronics makers to turn their products green. The push is from all sides—the government legislations, consumers and environment protection groups.

The European Union adopted RoHS (Restriction of Hazardous

Substances) directive way back in 2003 and enforcement started in 2006. China has its own laws called Administration on the Control of Pollution Caused by Electronic Information Products. India has drafted the e-Waste (Management and Handling) Rules which define the limits on usage of hazardous materials. So all export-oriented product development

in India requires use of green components, respecting the local laws of the export destination.

Worldwide and in India, people are becoming more and more environment-cautious. In addition, the rising cost of energy has made people take note of energy efficiency as one of the parameters while deciding products to buy.

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Incentives to go green

While exports to some countries bind the manufacturers to use only RoHS components, there are some incentives as well to go green. For instance, switching on to green electronics gives the manufacturers a marketing edge. Also, overall product costs go down ultimately.

“As per the current e-waste legislation of India, the manufacturers have to pay financially for recycling of the waste coming out of their products. If their product uses no toxic chemical and is highly recyclable, they, in fact, don't have to pay anything and can get their money back. As the cost of recycling isn't included, the overall cost reduces,” informs Abhishek Pratap, senior climate campaigner, Greenpeace India.

Most importantly, as you save money, you contribute towards saving the environment as well.

“Renesas Electronics has a corporate vision to harness the power of semiconductors to realise intel-